(17) Metric
Definition: Is any measurable number a business tracks - visits, calls made, units produced etc. It is just a measurement and does not have to be tied to a strategic goal. Not every metric is equally important.
Example: Daily website visitors is a metric for most businesses - useful to know, but on its own it does not tell you if the company is succeeding.
Source: Evans, J. R.

(18) Key Performance Indicator (KPI)
Definition: Is a metric directly tied to a company's strategic goals - it measures progress toward what the business wants to achieve. Every KPI is a metric, but not every metric is a KPI. The difference is whether the number drives decision at the highest level.
Example: For Uber, completed trips per day is a KPI because it directly measures whether the core business is working. Average driver login time is just a supporting metric.
Source: Investopedia (2024)

(19) Benchmark
Definition: Is a reference point you compare your performance against - usually an industry average, a competitor, or your own past results. Without it, numbers have no context.
Example: If the retail industry's average email open rate is 21% and yours is 28%, the benchmark tells you that you are performing above average.
Source: HubSpot (2024)